

BORICUA BREAKFASTS

Desayunos boricuas

Four mainland-proof morning recipes — warm, comforting, and ready before the coffee's done.

Mainland-tested · From the Ortiz kitchen

Hecho con corazón y sofrito · sofritostudio.com

Avena — Authentic Puerto Rican Oatmeal Drink Recipe

Avena

Creamy, cinnamon-spiced Puerto Rican oatmeal drink — the breakfast smoothie before smoothies existed.

Ingredients

- 1 cup rolled oats
- 4 cups water
- 1/2 cup sugar
- 1 teaspoon vanilla extract
- 1/2 teaspoon ground cinnamon
- Pinch of salt

Steps

1. Blend the oats with 2 cups of water until completely smooth.
2. Heat the remaining 2 cups of water with sugar and cinnamon in a medium pot over medium heat.
3. Strain the oat mixture into the hot water through a fine-mesh strainer, pressing to extract all liquid.
4. Add vanilla and salt. Simmer for 3 minutes, stirring constantly, until slightly thickened.
5. Serve warm or refrigerate and serve cold. Dust with extra cinnamon if desired.

Café con Leche — Authentic Puerto Rican Coffee with Milk Recipe

Cafe Con Leche

Strong, sweet, and creamy — the ritual that starts every morning on the island.

Ingredients

- 1/4 cup dark roast coffee (preferably Puerto Rican)
- 2 cups water
- 1 cup whole milk
- 2-3 tbsp sugar (adjust to taste)

Steps

1. Brew strong coffee using your preferred method — moka pot, French press, or traditional Puerto Rican cafetera.
2. Heat the milk in a small saucepan until steaming but not boiling. Froth if desired.
3. Pour coffee into cups, filling them about halfway. Top with steamed milk.
4. Add sugar to taste and stir. Serve immediately.

Chocolate Caliente Boricua — Authentic Puerto Rican Hot Chocolate Recipe

Chocolate Caliente

Real Puerto Rican hot chocolate — thick, cinnamon-spiced, and made with actual chocolate. Not the packet stuff.

Ingredients

- 4 oz Mexican chocolate (or dark chocolate + cinnamon)
- 4 cups milk
- 1/4 cup sugar
- 1 teaspoon vanilla extract
- Pinch of salt
- Cinnamon sticks for serving

Steps

1. Heat the milk in a saucepan over medium heat until steaming, not boiling.
2. Add the chocolate and stir continuously until completely melted and incorporated.
3. Add sugar, vanilla, and a pinch of salt. Whisk vigorously until frothy.
4. Pour into mugs and serve with a cinnamon stick for stirring.

Mallorcas — Puerto Rican Sweet Bread Rolls

Recipe

Mallorcas

Buttery, slightly dense sweet bread rolls — the Puerto Rican breakfast staple dusted with powdered sugar and dipped in café con leche.

Ingredients

- 3 cups all-purpose flour
- 1/4 cup sugar
- 1 packet active dry yeast
- 1/2 cup warm milk
- 1/3 cup butter, softened
- 2 large eggs
- 1 teaspoon vanilla extract
- 1/2 teaspoon salt
- Powdered sugar for dusting

Steps

1. Bloom the yeast: dissolve yeast in warm milk (110°F) with a pinch of sugar. Let sit 5-10 minutes until foamy.
2. In a large bowl, mix flour, sugar, and salt. Add the yeast mixture, softened butter, eggs, and vanilla. Mix until a shaggy dough forms.
3. Knead the dough on a floured surface for 10 minutes until smooth and elastic. It should spring back when poked.
4. Place in a greased bowl, cover, and let rise in a warm spot for 1 hour until doubled in size.
5. Punch down the dough and divide into 12 equal balls. Place in a greased 9x13 baking pan. Cover and let rise another 30 minutes.
6. Bake at 375°F for 18-20 minutes until golden on top. Dust generously with powdered sugar while still warm.